



Individual Instructor Report Fall 2022 Version A for STA 301 - INTRODUCTION TO DATA SCIENCE (05260) (Henrique Bolfarine)

Project Title: **Instructor Course Evaluations Fall 2022**

Courses Audience: **68**

Responses Received: **33**

Response Ratio: **48.5%**

Report Comments

Results were produced during the Fall 2022 implementation of new course evaluation questions and systems. Courses with final exams conducted on December 8th, 2022, may have overlapped with the evaluation window.

Guide to the Interpretation of Course Evaluations at UT Austin

The goal of course evaluation process at UT Austin is to drive teaching excellence and to support continuous improvement in teaching and learning experiences. The two sets of scales used for core evaluation questions and the associated weights are:

Strongly Agree (5)
Agree (4)
Neutral (3)
Disagree (2)
Strongly Disagree (1)

Excellent (5)
Very Good (4)
Satisfactory (3)
Unsatisfactory (2)
Very Unsatisfactory (1)

The Mean is calculated by adding all of the weights for a single question and dividing by the number of respondents. The course workload question is not averaged.

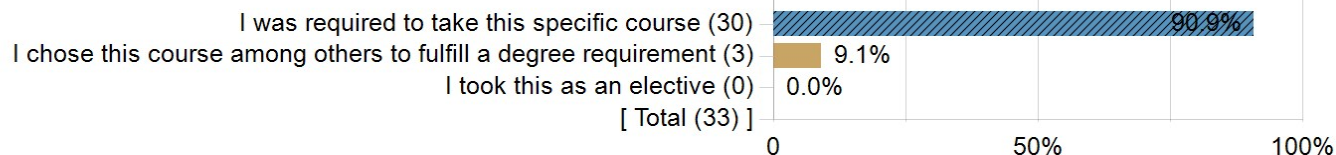
The number of students (e.g. Respondents) marking each option is reported for each of the items. These frequency distributions provide information about the level of student ratings and the spread and shape of the class distribution of responses. The distributions thus provide a picture of student perception of a course.

Course evaluations provide snapshots of student perspectives on their course-level learning experiences. Most experts on teaching evaluation advise that no one method gives the complete picture of an instructor's teaching effectiveness; multiple and diverse measures, on multiple occasions, are advised to give a full picture of the teaching effectiveness of a particular instructor. Moreover, other factors, such as size of class, level of the class, and content of the course, can cause small variations in the ratings. Therefore, student perspectives for a particular instructor or course should be interpreted as a snapshot, and not as providing complete information on the teaching effectiveness of that instructor.

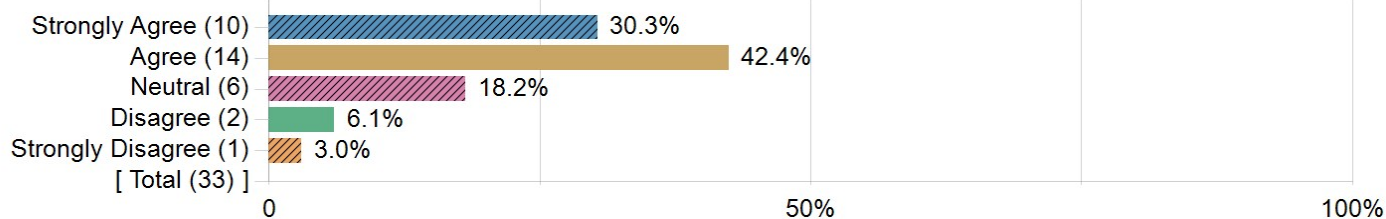
Creation Date: **Friday, May 5, 2023**

Course Questions

Why did you take this course?



During this course, I gained a deeper understanding of the subject matter.



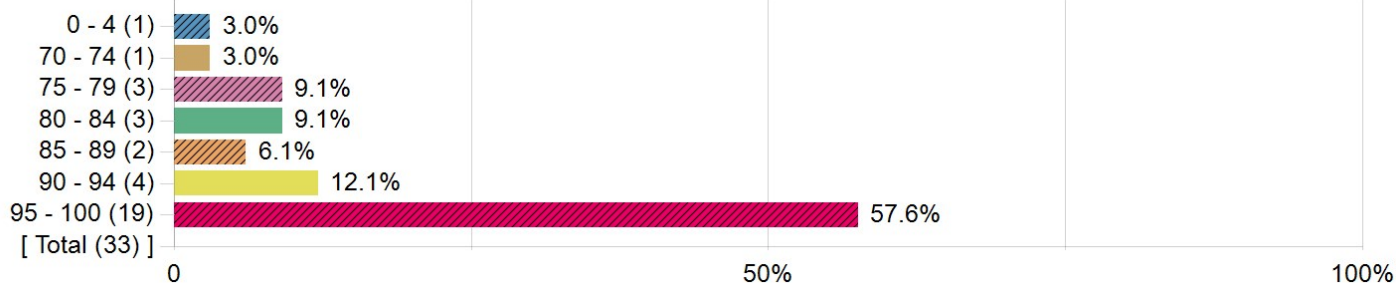
Statistics

Value

Mean

3.91

Overall, approximately what percentage of the course meetings did you attend or complete (online, in person, or asynchronously)?



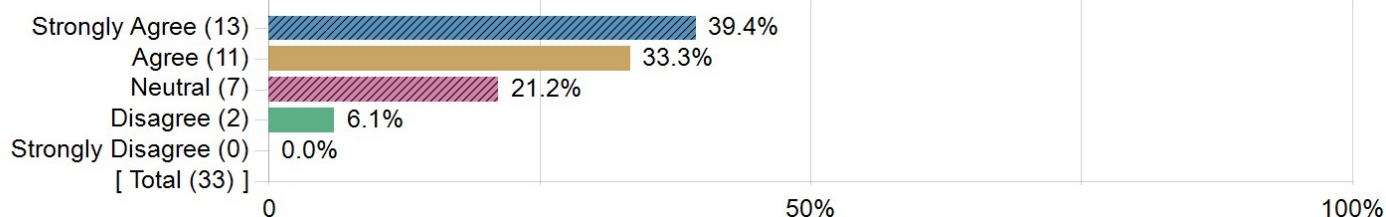
Statistics

Value

Mean

89.30

The course assignments improved my ability to apply logical, numerical, or statistical skills to real-world problems.



Statistics

Value

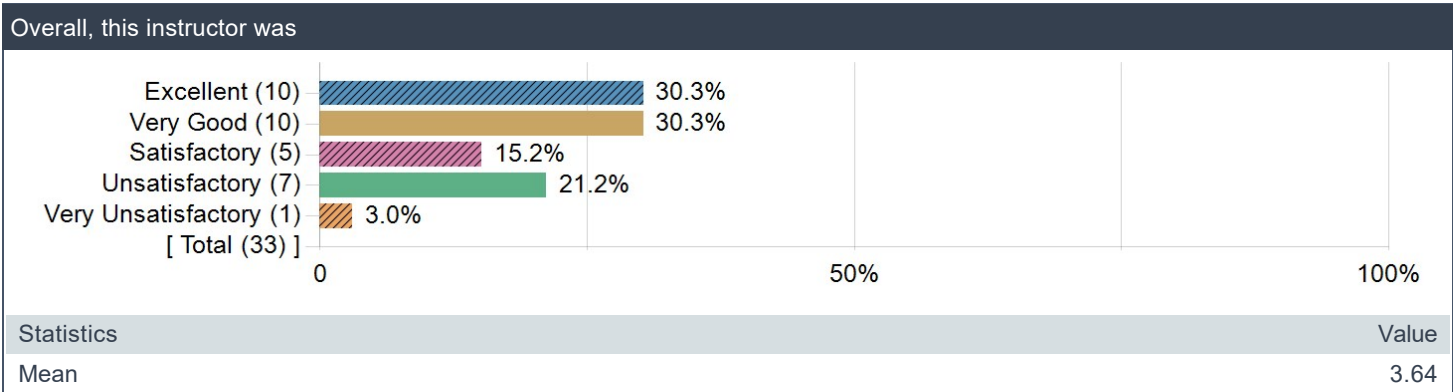
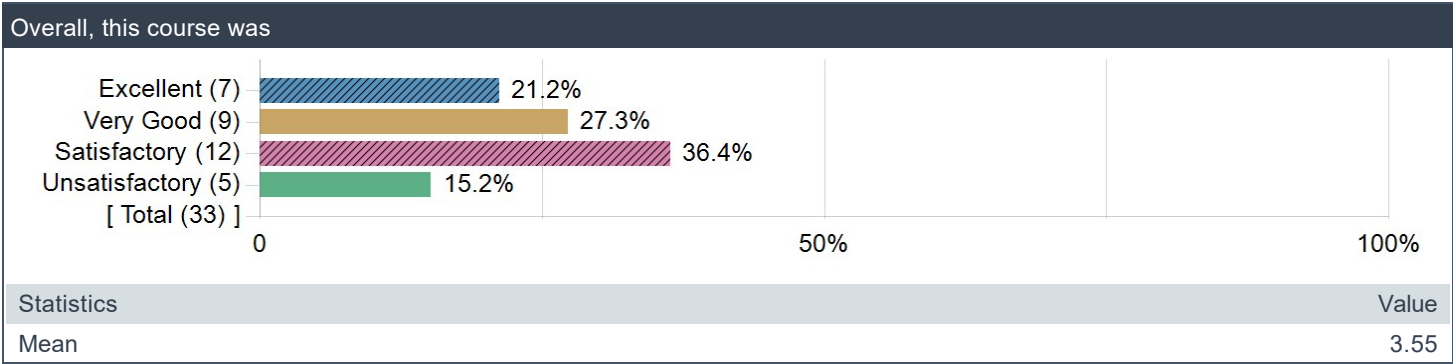
Mean

4.06

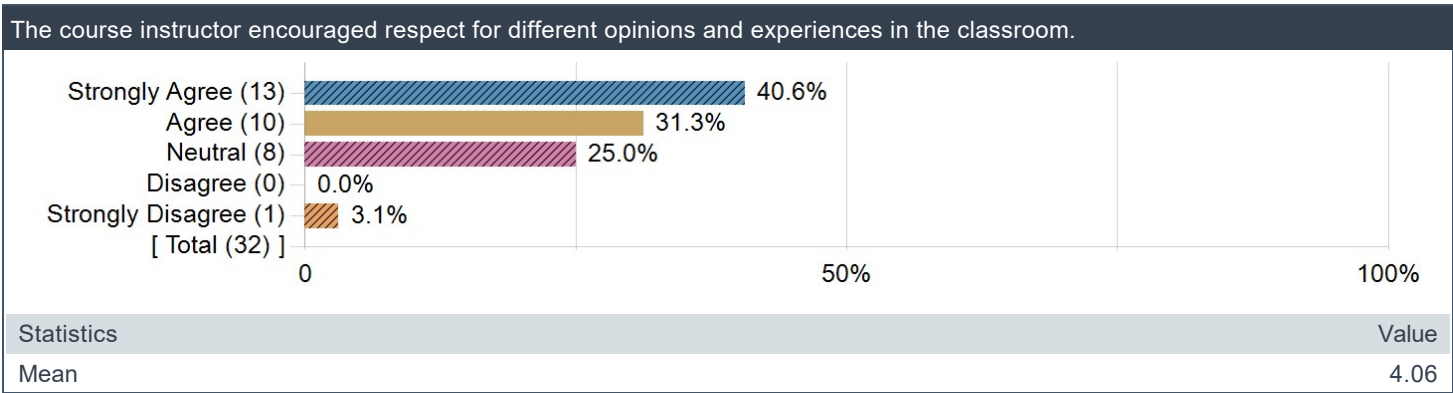
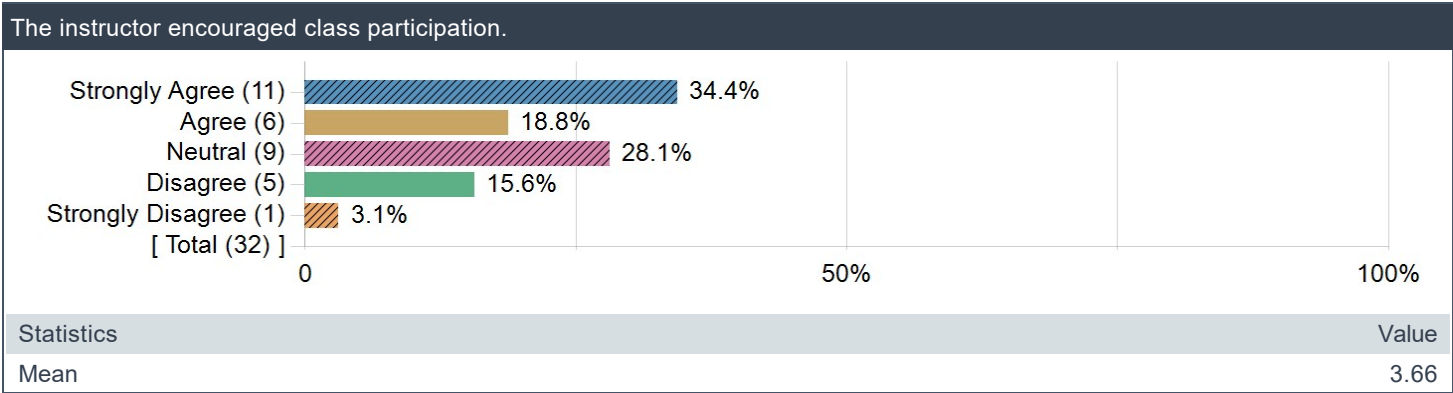
Instructor Questions

	Strongly Agree	Agree	Neutral	Disagree	Strongly Disagree	Responded	Mean
The instructor clearly explained the course objectives and expectations.	24.2%	45.5%	21.2%	3.0%	6.1%	33	3.79
The instructor fostered an inclusive learning environment.	36.4%	33.3%	24.2%	3.0%	3.0%	33	3.97
The instructor effectively explained the concepts and subject matter in this course.	27.3%	30.3%	15.2%	21.2%	6.1%	33	3.52
The instructional techniques kept me engaged in learning.	24.2%	21.2%	15.2%	24.2%	15.2%	33	3.15
The instructor checked for student understanding of the concepts presented in the course.	33.3%	24.2%	21.2%	18.2%	3.0%	33	3.67

Overall Questions



College, School, or Unit Questions



Comment Questions

Identify aspects of the course that were the most effective in helping your learning.

Comments
r studio
The thing that was most effective in helping my learning were the KCs. This was because it made sure that I understood the material we learned in class right after we did it.
Dr. Bolfarine was very kind and willing to help to the best of his ability.
When we practiced looking through R in class it was helpful to connect the concepts with the application.
KC's
The most effective aspect of the course that helped me learn was watching the professor do example problems during lectures as he explained certain concepts. Some topics within statistics are hard to grasp, but getting to follow along on example problems solidified my understanding of what to do during certain questions and the why behind them. Also, Prof. Bolfarine was awesome, he was easy to talk to especially if you had any questions and he explain concepts really well which definitely helped in this course.
I learned mostly from the book, so reviewing that helped me a lot.
Working on R studio during class, the zoom videos of the class so that if we miss anything we can go back, the slides, and the textbook are all super amazing.
The required Knowledge Checks actually "forced" me to learn, so I guess they were most effective in making me learn.
Homework's, the textbook, knowledge checks
I liked the textbook that was provided. It really helped me get a better understanding of the course material.
The homework assignments and lectures going over the material.
The knowledge checks
The textbook.
Attending office hours with the professor
Good instruction
Textbook readings
Knowledge Checks
Knowledge Checks
knowledge checks
The textbook and going through the code in class together was very helpful

Identify the aspect of the course that you found most challenging, why you found it was challenging, and suggest one thing that could be done to help future students meet that challenge more effectively.

Comments
definitions of statistics terms
This was by far my hardest class. Everything was difficult for me but especially learning/using R script. I had never even heard of R before this class so it was hard to get good at it fast. One thing that could possible help students is to send out basic R instruction videos before class starts to allow students to get ahead on learning the basic functions of R.
There were very little fluctuations in teaching style. Dr. Bolfarine admitted that he had to go along with the teaching styles of the other statistics professors, but many students agreed that this made it very difficult to understand. TA office hours were generally a negative experience, with TAs sometimes not even showing up and giving no warning. Most everyone (before the curve) failed the midterm, and we were simply told that we would "be fine" by the final. Two weeks before the final, I currently do not feel "fine," and many other students that I have talked to feel the same. I would recommend that Dr. Bolfarine take his own approach to teaching, as he often voiced that the method that he was teaching with was one he did not agree with. I would also recommend that he clearly explain his expectations to his TAs and advise them to help instead of rushing out, not showing up, or speaking to students as if they were stupid.
All of our grades and assignments came from using R and solving problems with the computer software. I struggled with this because in class we almost only talked about the conceptual concepts of statistics— something I was familiar with.
I found the textbook less useful and often more confusing when it didn't align with the quiz.
The most challenging aspect of the course for me was the amount of time we had for the midterm. The course itself and the assignments were really good, however, the given time for the midterm for the number of questions we had was a little unrealistic. I think the time would have worked perfectly if it was an upper division class, but given that the concept of coding is new to more than 50% of the class it was hard to be able to fully think through and code problems in such a short amount of time.
The most challenging would be perhaps having a cheat r studio sheet, just to help with short cuts because sometimes the textbooks way is super long and easy to mess up.
What I found most challenging is the professor's teaching. I found it challenging because his lectures are not engaging; for the most part, he recites what is on the PowerPoint slides. Perhaps if he had more energy in his teaching or implemented more "fun" activities, it would make the course much easier to learn. This class became where I would catch up on errands like checking emails or catching up on work for my other classes. It did not feel like my attendance for that class provided much value to my success since everything I needed was the posted slides and the online textbook.
I found it challenging to stay engaged in class
I think the most challenging part is the homework. I would recommend for people to get together with other students to be successful in the homeworks.
The homework assignments and how often we had assignments. Separating the time in between assignments would be helpful.
The tests.
n/a
Difficult material
R studio
I found it challenging being able to apply the material to homework and knowledge checks.
Lectures very confusing/ slow
Balancing the workload of a homework with knowledge checks when an upcoming midterm was approaching was difficult. Better scheduling would help to mitigate stress.
learning to code in R
coding in beginning
I had a really hard time learning from this professor, he did a really bad job of explaining how to actually do the R studio coding.
Learning the code was very challenging. I would recommend fully doing the KC instead of just guessing your way through them